

languages which won't work on Linux are: C#, Visual Basic, Swift and Objective C because they were build by Microsoft and Apple for their respective platforms only.

But that was very much the landscape back in 2005-2006 too, right? So what is new? The new is – many tools and frameworks have sprung up which allow you to develop cross-platform apps. For example, you can make a C++ app using the Qt framework on Linux and be pretty sure that it can work on Windows and Mac too as long as you have not used any Linux-specific code which cannot run anywhere. You can create a website in PHP using Windows and given you have maintained the modularity and portability of your website's codebase, it will work on a Linux server without trouble. A decade ago, it was not exactly the scene. Many frameworks came up in the last decade which have helped move the developer's focus from "How do I get to run this code on XYZ platform" to "How do I implement the new feature?" This is one of the key points where Linux has made a significant progress – getting into the list of target platforms for many cross-platform development IDEs, frameworks and languages.

Are you a developer? Well, Linux's got your back, sire!

Linux is made of air – it runs the cloud, after all

So you want to launch a new website or a back-end service on the Internet and your predictive abilities guide you to consider scaling your site or service on to multiple servers. So what do you do? You create a virtual machine instance. And what do you choose for the OS? Well, as long as your code is cross-platform compatible, it is very likely that you would choose Linux because it is much cheaper than Windows. For the same reason, Linux has been the most popular OS that gets the cloud(s) blooming.

Be it DigitalOcean or AWS or Rackspace, you would get Ubuntu server everywhere. In most cases you would also have the freedom to choose from Debian, RedHat, SLES etc. Even if you want to go for shared hosting services, Linux is everywhere. Hence, the popularity has been increasing.

So should I try Linux? And if yes, where do I begin?

We hope, by now you should be ready enough to give that beast a run, at least on virtualisation software. Testing on real or virtual machine is your choice but we are going to tell you which one you should try. Now, you need not stick to our suggestions, feel free to try other distros. But depending